

Fixing File Sync and Upload Problems

article_id: kb-sync-002 | product_area: sync | last_updated: 2026-05-18

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Overview

File synchronization is a core capability of Nimbus, enabling seamless access to files across devices. However, users sometimes encounter sync stalls, conflicts, or upload failures. This article provides support agents with a comprehensive guide to diagnosing and resolving sync-related issues, complete with troubleshooting tables, FAQs, and escalation procedures.

Common Customer Symptoms

- Files remain in a **"sync pending"** state for an extended period.
- Duplicate *conflicted copy* files appear after editing on multiple devices.
- Upload attempts fail with a *file too large* or *network error* message.
- Sync stops after switching Wi-Fi networks or connecting to a corporate VPN.
- Specific folders are not syncing despite being selected.

Root Causes

Symptom	Typical Cause
Sync pending	Large upload queue, unstable network, paused sync, or local file lock.
Conflicted copy	Simultaneous edits on different devices before upload completion.
Upload >2 GB	Application-enforced single-file size limit.
Sync pause after network change	Firewall blocks required ports, VPN DNS routing issues.
Folder excluded unintentionally	User mistakenly used "Don't sync on this device" .

Detailed Troubleshooting Steps

- **Check Sync Service Status**
 - Open the tray icon -> **Sync Dashboard**. Look for any global outage notices.
- **Inspect Queue Length**
 - Open **Sync Queue**. If the queue exceeds 50 items, advise the user to pause and resume sync to reset the queue.
- **Verify Network Stability**

- Run a speed test; ensure latency < 150 ms and no packet loss. Prefer a wired Ethernet connection for large batches.

• Resolve Conflicted Copies

- Locate files named `filename (conflicted copy, DEVICE, DATE).ext`.
- Open both versions, merge changes, delete the conflicted copy, and confirm the remaining file syncs.

• Handle Large Files

- For files larger than 2 GB, compress them into a zip archive or split them using a tool like `split` before uploading.

• Recover After Network Change

- After switching networks, click the **Sync** icon and select **Resume**.
- If the badge shows "**connection blocked**", ensure outbound HTTPS (port 443) is allowed and that corporate firewalls permit `*.nimbuscloud.com`.

• Review Folder Exclusion Settings

- Right-click the folder -> **Sync Settings** -> verify "**Sync on this device**" is enabled.
- Re-include the folder and allow a full re-download (may take time for large folders).

• Consult Error Codes

- Refer to the **Error Code Reference** article for codes like NB-SYNC-101 or NB-UP-317 that may appear in the sync log.

Troubleshooting Tables

Sync Queue Errors

Error Code	Meaning	Common Cause	Recommended Resolution
SYNC-101	Queue stalled > 30 min	Large batch or network hiccup	Pause & resume sync; ensure stable connection
SYNC-204	Folder missing in cloud	Remote deletion before sync	Re-create folder locally, then move files back
SYNC-305	Persistent "connection blocked"	Firewall or VPN blocking ports	Open port 443 outbound, whitelist <code>*.nimbuscloud.com</code>

Conflict Resolution Table

Scenario	Indicator	Action
Two devices edited same file	<code>conflicted copy</code> suffix	Merge manually, delete conflicted copy

Automatic conflict detection disabled	No conflict files appear	Enable "Detect conflicts" in Settings -> Sync -> Advanced
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Examples and Edge Cases

- **Case A:** User reports a single large video file stuck at *sync pending* for 2 hours. Investigation shows the file size is 3.2 GB, exceeding the limit. After compressing to a zip (1.1 GB) and uploading, sync completes.
- **Case B:** After a corporate VPN rollout, multiple users see *connection blocked*. Network team added an exception for *.nimbuscloud.com on port 443, resolving the issue.
- **Case C:** A user unintentionally excluded the **Projects** folder. Re-enabling sync triggered a full re-download of 500 MB of data.

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

- **Why does my file stay "sync pending" even after I restart the app?** The sync queue may be stuck. Pausing and resuming forces a re-scan.
- **Can I configure a higher upload limit for large files?** No. The 2 GB limit is enforced for all plans to ensure stability.
- **What should I do if I see many conflicted copy files?** Review each conflict, merge changes, and delete the extra copies.
- **Is there a way to prioritize certain folders in the sync queue?** Yes. Right-click a folder -> **Prioritize Sync** moves it to the front of the queue.
- **When should I escalate a sync issue?** Escalate if the queue remains stalled after three pause/resume attempts, or if error codes persist despite remediation.

Escalation Guidance

- **Trigger 1:** Sync queue remains > 30 min after three pause/resume cycles.
- **Trigger 2:** Repeated NB-SYNC-101 errors across multiple devices.
- **Trigger 3:** Large-file upload failures despite compression and network stability.
- **Trigger 4:** Corporate network blocks persist after firewall rule changes.

Create a **Sync Escalation Ticket** containing:

- User ID and device details.
- Full sync log excerpt (Settings -> Help -> Show Logs).
- List of error codes observed.
- Steps already taken.

Cross-Article References

- See **Error Code Reference** for detailed error meanings.

- Refer to **Account Access** for authentication-related sync failures.
- Consult **Mobile App Sync** for mobile-specific sync behavior.

Support Notes (Internal)

- Known issue: On macOS 13, the sync daemon may hang after a system sleep. Workaround: restart the NimbusSync service via Activity Monitor.
- For VPN environments, recommend a split-tunnel configuration to keep sync traffic direct.
- Log all escalation tickets with sync queue snapshots for future analysis.

Last updated: 2026-05-18